ESSAY EXAMPLES

ESSAY #1 - Santería

> *Some students have a background, identity, interest, or talent that is so meaningful they believe their application would be incomplete without it. If this sounds like you, then please share your story.*

In her cramped kitchen, Titi Nana cracked the egg in the center of the pan, the cheeriness of the bright yellow yolk contrasting the harshness of the caldero. In a flourish, she jerked the bottle of alcohol in her hand, flames erupting from the griddle. She instructed me: "Wipe it all off," gesturing to dust off my shoulders and arms into the inferno. I laughed nervously as I removed the *maldad* [evil] from my body, one brush at a time.

I left Titi's apartment that day confused about how our family's practice of Santería [witchcraft] fit in with my outward embrace of my heritage. I felt as if the parts of my Latina identity I claimed openly -- dancing salsa to Celia Cruz or enjoying *lechón y arroz con habichuelas en Navidad* -- were contradicted by my skepticism towards Titi's rituals. My experience with Santería wasn't new, as proven by my mother's kitchen altar lit dimly by prayer candles and adorned with evil eyes, statues of San Miguel, and offerings to Elegua; however, I'd never before witnessed such a tangible demonstration of my family's ritualistic beliefs. Although it surrounded me, I refused to believe in the effects of Santería... so I shunned it entirely.

Moving to a predominantly white boarding school and away from the rituals my family had passed down, I avoided addressing the distance I had wedged between myself and my background. I pushed away all things Latina as my fear of failing to honor my Puerto Rican heritage intensified. This distance only grew as my classmates jokingly commented on my inability to speak Spanish and my white-passing complexion, further tearing away bits of my Latinidad with each snide remark.

In an effort to build myself back up, I began to practice the small bits of Santería that I comprehended: lighting candles for good luck, placing a chalice of water by my bedside to absorb all *maldad*, and saying my prayers to San Miguel and my guardian angels each day. To my disbelief, the comments that attacked my Latinidad, or lack thereof, faded along with the aching feeling that I had failed to represent my

FASHIONNOVA

AUTHORIZED PACKING LIST

VENDOR NAME:	WISH FOR FALLING STAR	PO NUMBER:	1112664
STYLE:	DR4905	DESCRIPTION:	Into The Garden Scarf Mesh Maxi Dress

CARTON # FROM	CARTON # TO	QTY CARTONS	COLOR	SIZE RATIO - Women's Regular XXS	XS	S	M	L	XL	1X	2X	3X	4X			UNITS PER CARTON	TOTAL QUANTITY
1	1	1	BLACK/COMBO		52											52	52
2	3	2	BLACK/COMBO			50										50	100
4	4	1	BLACK/COMBO			15										15	15
5	7	3	BLACK/COMBO				50									50	150
8	8	1	BLACK/COMBO				47									47	47
9	11	3	BLACK/COMBO					50								50	150
12	12	1	BLACK/COMBO					18								18	18
13	14	2	BLACK/COMBO						45							45	90
15	15	1	BLACK/COMBO						15							15	15

SELF:95%POLYESTER,5%SPANDEX LINING:100%POLYESTER

TOTAL CARTONS:	15
TOTAL UNITS:	637

FN Receiver / Date | Receiving Clerk Initials | Driver's Printed Name | Total # of Boxes

Shipment Summary

Color	QTY	XSS	XS	S	M	L	XL	1X	2X	3X	4X
BLACK/COMBO	637		52	115	197	168	105				

Quarterly review 1

- Revenue up
- Costs down
- Next steps

FASHIONNOVA

AUTHORIZED PACKING LIST

VENDOR NAME:	WISH FOR FALLING STAR	PO NUMBER:	1086173
STYLE:	DR3775	DESCRIPTION:	Felicity Sequin Feather Gown

CARTON # FROM	CARTON # TO	QTY CARTONS	COLOR	SIZE RATIO - Women's Regular												UNITS PER CARTON	TOTAL QUANTITY
				XXS	XS	S	M	L	XL	1X	2X	3X	4X				
1	1	1	BLACK		10											10	10
2	2	1	BLACK			20										20	20
3	4	2	BLACK				22									22	44
5	5	1	BLACK				5									5	5
6	7	2	BLACK					22								22	44
8	8	1	BLACK					6								6	6
9	9	1	BLACK						20							20	20
10	10	1	BLACK						10							10	10
11	12	2	BLACK							20						20	40
13	13	1	BLACK								18					18	18
14	14	1	BLACK								12					12	12
15	15	1	BLACK									15				15	15
16	16	1	BLACK									5				5	5

SELF:100%POLYESTER CONTRAST:96%POLYESTER,4%SPANDEX LINING:90%POLYESTER,10%SPANDEX

TOTAL CARTONS:	16
TOTAL UNITS:	249

FN Receiver / Date

Receiving Clerk Initials

Driver's Printed Name

Total # of Boxes

Shipment Summary

Color	QTY	XSS	XS	S	M	L	XL	1X	2X	3X	4X
BLACK	249		10	20	49	50	30	40	30	20	